

Report conversation

Why can't I validate a self signed http tls certificate between two servers isolated from internet?

When you have two servers isolated from the internet and want to validate a self-signed HTTP TLS certificate, there are a few reasons why it may not be possible:

1. **Lack of certificate authority:** Self-signed certificates are not signed by a trusted certificate authority (CA). In an isolated environment, there may be no CA infrastructure available to validate the certificate's authenticity.
2. **Absence of certificate revocation checks:** Certificate revocation checks require contacting the issuing CA or an online revocation list (CRL). Without internet connectivity, the servers won't be able to verify if the certificate has been revoked.
3. **Inability to perform certificate chain verification:** When using a self-signed certificate, there is no certificate chain leading to a trusted root CA. Verifying the certificate chain requires access to the necessary intermediate and root certificates, which may not be available in an isolated environment.

In such cases, self-signed certificates can still be used for securing the connection between the isolated servers, but the certificate's authenticity cannot be verified in the traditional way. It's important to ensure other security measures are in place, such as secure network communication and strong access controls, to maintain the integrity and confidentiality of the connection.